

How to launch PC settings

There are many ways to launch the PC settings.

- ▶ The first and the easiest is to bring up the Charms bar – hover the mouse near the top-right or bottom-right corner and click on Settings, then click on the ‘Change PC settings’ in the panel that comes up.
- ▶ The second method is to hit the start button and type ‘PC settings’ in the search box (or you can use the Charms bar to get to search box).
- ▶ The third is to create a shortcut for PC settings on the start menu or taskbar and then use it.

Creating new user accounts

You need to launch PC settings and go to the Users section. On the right pane (if your screen is taller than wider, it would open in another screen), you’d have an option to ‘Add a user’ besides a (+) symbol at the bottom. Click that and you’d be prompted to enter the user’s Microsoft account email address (the one used to sign in to Windows 8 or the Microsoft website). If you don’t have that email address, you may click on the ‘Sign-in without a Microsoft account’ at the bottom. Supposing you opted to not use the Microsoft account, you’d be taken to a screen trying to sell you on the advantages of using a Microsoft account. Click on the ‘Local Account’ button at the bottom to continue.

Windows would then ask you to enter a user name, password (twice, of course) and password hint. If your password hint contains the password itself, Windows won’t accept it – a good security measure. In the end you can indicate if the account you’re creating is a child’s account. Marking the account as a child account will allow you to monitor and manage the PC usage by that account in the Family Safety center. One more click and your account is ready.

Changing your own password

Open up PC settings, go to the Users section and click on the ‘Change your password’ button. You’ll be prompted to enter your current password and your new password, twice and that’s it. Beware though – if you use Microsoft account to sign in to Windows 8, changing your password in Windows 8 will also change it on its servers. Sadly, Windows 8 no longer allows a password with more than 16 characters if you want to use a Microsoft account. The only way to bypass this limitation is to switch to a local account and disconnect the automated syncing features. We’d call it an disadvantageous move given that other parts of the OS have improved the security.